

North Star Summit 2026–2027 Syllabus

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Tentative dates; meeting times to be confirmed in Eastern time. Grade 12, about six students, with two school teachers. Calls are monthly in the fall and about every three weeks January–March. Most work is asynchronous. Sheets finish before winter break; Python starts in mid-January; presentations finish in mid-April.

Our rhythm: introduction → questions → work due → feedback. School breaks can lengthen a cycle.

October to December 2026 — Spreadsheets

Assignment or activity	Live class date	Due date or feedback
Meet Mr. Hayward; opening slides; start your own Sheet	Oct 15, 2026	—
Submit your goals and first spreadsheet questions through Forms	—	Oct 22, 2026
First spreadsheet attempt: six answers, formulas and Sheet link	—	Nov 5, 2026
Spreadsheet feedback; introduce optional streak and VLOOKUP bonuses	Nov 12, 2026	Feedback: Nov 12
Send remaining spreadsheet or bonus questions	—	Nov 18, 2026
Finish Sheets: six answers, explanations and any optional bonus work	Dec 3, 2026	Dec 3, 2026
Mr. Hayward returns final spreadsheet feedback	—	Dec 10, 2026

How to submit: Work in your own Sheet and Colab. Open the assignment Form, sign in with your school account, type the answers, paste code and results, and include your file link. Paste the full teacher letter into its Form. Press Submit and keep the confirmation. Teachers receive a timestamped response. Resubmit after revisions; the latest response is reviewed.

Breaks: No required course work December 11–January 13. Pause for October 26–30 and January 19–22 assessments, and March 22–April 2 assessments/spring break.

January to April 2027 — Python, Gemini and presentations

Assignment or activity	Live class date	Due date or feedback
A02: start Python in your personal Colab	Jan 14, 2027	Questions: Jan 28
A02: submit six answers, Python code, results and Colab link	—	Feb 4, 2027
A03 and A03R: compare weekdays; write a letter to your teacher	Feb 4, 2027	Questions: Feb 11
Mr. Hayward returns A02 feedback	—	Feb 11, 2027
A03 and A03R: submit answers/code and the complete 150–250 word letter through their Forms	—	Feb 18, 2027
A04 and A05: histogram and time-series charts; review weekday analysis and letter	Feb 25, 2027	A03/A03R feedback: Feb 25
Send questions about the two chart tasks	—	Mar 4, 2027
A04 and A05: submit code, chart interpretation, results and Colab link	—	Mar 11, 2027
Gemini workshop: redo one Sheets task and one Python/chart task; review charts	Mar 18, 2027	A04/A05 feedback: Mar 18
Send Gemini and presentation questions before the school pause	—	Mar 19, 2027
AI: submit artifact, prompts, pros/cons and two independent checks. A06: submit a four-slide presentation draft.	—	Apr 8, 2027
Mr. Hayward returns Gemini and presentation-draft feedback	—	Apr 12, 2027
A06: final presentations; submit Slides link and reflection	Apr 15, 2027	Apr 15, 2027
Mr. Hayward returns final presentation feedback	—	Apr 19, 2027

Gemini: Redo one Sheets task and one Python/chart task using only the public teaching dataset. Submit prompts, an artifact, pros/cons and two numerical checks. A teacher-provided response is available if Gemini is unavailable.

Privacy: The website has no student login or completion status. Google protects personal files and records Form submissions. Keep work restricted to the student, Mr. Hayward and the two teachers. Course hub: haywarddatascience.com/summit